INTERNATIONAL EXPERIENCE

CH Zurich (2020–present) · GB London (2015–2020) · FR Paris (2013–2014)



Thomas Zijlstra, CFA

AI Commercialization & Enterprise AI Builder

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Work permit: EU · Switzerland ·

English (Fluent) · German (Fluent) · Dutch (Fluent)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Financial services professional with a decade of international experience across London, Zurich, and Paris. Early career in investment banking: Debt Capital Markets at Société Générale covering DACH and Benelux financial institutions, followed by investment and financing work at a London family office. Since 2020, based in Zurich delivering enterprise AI for regulated financial-services organisations. Currently leading the end-to-end AI-automated compliance workflow at a major European reinsurer—strategy, economics, roadmap, and agentic AI implementation across the full regulatory change lifecycle. Prior delivery spans FINMA regulatory reporting, OeNB central-bank audit, and NFR AI practice leadership across the DACH region. CFA charterholder.

EXPERIENCE

> Accenture, 🇨🇭 Zurich

Jun 2020 – Present

Financial Services AI & Digital Transformation

- End-to-end ownership of an AI-automated compliance workflow at a leading European reinsurer: strategy, economics, roadmap, and hands-on implementation of agentic AI across the full regulatory change lifecycle.
- Architecture and delivery of AI-agent workflows for RCSA, TPRM, DORA, and regulatory change — covering LLM orchestration, knowledge graphs, document intelligence, enterprise system integrations, and human-in-the-loop approval gates.
- Switzerland NFR Capabilities Team Lead: built and led the local AI and NFR practice, defining go-to-market for the DACH region within the CFO&EV division.
- Led origination and end-to-end delivery of a FINMA regulatory reporting and data adequacy programme at a leading Swiss insurer, including Databricks data-platform implementation.
- Stream Lead for an OeNB central-bank audit at a European core banking provider.
- LIBOR and interest-rate-transition delivery at a European GSIB, drawing on capital-markets experience across derivatives, valuation, and trading-desk structures.
- Coordination across CRO, COO, risk, data, technology, governance, and regulatory stakeholders in regulated financial-services environments.

• Single Family Office, 🇬🇧 London

Aug 2018 – Mar 2020

Investment & Finance Manager

- Company valuation and cash-flow modelling.
- Direct-investment and financing analysis.
- Debt, asset-backed, and equity-financing discussions.
- Engagement with investors, portfolio companies, and financing counterparties.
- Work in an entrepreneurial, growth-stage environment.

■ Société Générale, 🇬🇧 London

Jun 2015 – Jul 2018

Debt Capital Markets Analyst, FIG — DACH and Benelux (selected UK/Ireland)

- DCM origination, structuring, and execution.
- Senior, Tier 2, covered, RMBS, subordinated, and green-bond products.
- Capital-markets reporting, credit work, liquidity analysis, capacity analysis.
- Coordination with M&A, ECM, Legal, Syndication.
- Derivatives, structured products, IRS, FX options, structured notes.

- **Catalina, Paris** Jun 2013 – Jan 2014

Data Scientist (Traineeship)

— Consumer and purchasing-behaviour analysis.

— Statistical analysis of transaction data.

— Price-elasticity and product-portfolio analysis.

— Translation of analytical findings into client recommendations.

SELECTED PUBLIC PROJECTS

Enterprise NFR Agent Platform

Public technical demonstrator · https://github.com/tzijlstra-acn/RealAIInfrastrucure

- Enterprise platform built around multiple AI agent workflows—each handling a different NFR domain—with a shared knowledge graph, document intelligence, regulatory analysis, human approval gates, and enterprise integration patterns. Built as a technical demonstrator of what a production-grade enterprise AI stack looks like in practice.
- Commercial relevance: Individual AI use cases tend to stay isolated from each other. This platform shows what it looks like when they share a knowledge graph, common agent infrastructure, and consistent approval patterns—the architecture of a platform rather than a collection of disconnected pilots.
- Note: Synthetic demonstration · no client data · not a production deployment

DORA Article 12 AI Control Line

Enterprise workflow demonstrator · https://github.com/tzijlstra-acn/ProReinsuranceAIWorkflow

- A fully functional AI workflow demonstrator built around a real regulatory requirement (DORA Article 12). Uses synthetic and anonymized data throughout. Takes a regulatory input through AI-generated control updates, infrastructure proposals, policy-engine verification, compliance documentation, human approval gates, and a complete traceable evidence chain.
- Commercial relevance: Demonstrates the full architecture of an enterprise AI workflow: model integration (OpenAI o3 for regulatory reasoning, GPT-4o for infrastructure, GPT-4o-mini for documentation), an 11-state machine for end-to-end traceability, and human approval gates at every consequential step. Built using only synthetic and anonymized data.
- Note: Demonstrator using synthetic and anonymized data · no client systems, credentials, or confidential information · integration patterns are illustrative

Enterprise AI Economics Simulator

Public executive decision tool · https://github.com/tzijlstra-acn/AICostSimulator

- Interactive tool for modelling the full economics of an enterprise AI platform—model selection and routing, token costs, cloud vs. sovereign vs. on-premise hosting, shared infrastructure costs, governance overhead, and net value projections. Built for executive decision-making and proposal development.
- Commercial relevance: Useful for buyers and architects who need to model the full economics of an AI platform investment—not only capability but also what shared infrastructure and governance overhead do to unit economics.
- Note: All prices, benchmarks, gains, and allocation values are illustrative planning assumptions.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

CFA Charterholder

CFA Institute

MSc Finance and Investments

2014 – 2015

Rotterdam School of Management, Erasmus University

Cum laude · 8.5/10

Thesis: "Credit rating changes and their effect on asymmetric information"

BSc International Business Administration

2011 – 2014

Rotterdam School of Management

Honours · 8.1/10

CAPABILITIES

Commercial & Strategic

AI commercialization · opportunity qualification · customer discovery · buyer/stakeholder mapping · executive communication · financial modelling · AI economics · proposal development · paid-pilot design · program delivery · commercial hypothesis testing · expansion-playbook design

AI & Architecture

agentic workflows · LangGraph · LangChain · human-in-the-loop · knowledge graphs · document intelligence · model-provider abstraction · evaluation design · AI governance · model-routing and cost models · NIST AI RMF · shadow AI detection · autonomous operations

Engineering & Integration

Python · FastAPI · REST APIs · ServiceNow integration patterns · MCP · NetworkX · SQLite · TypeScript · JavaScript · React · Next.js · HTML/CSS · workflow state machines · Terraform · AWS architecture · Recharts · Vite · TanStack Query · Radix UI · Tailwind CSS · pnpm

Financial Services

Non-Financial Risk · RCSA · TPRM · DORA · AI risk management · regulatory reporting · data adequacy · LIBOR transition · capital markets · FIG · derivatives/valuation concepts

LANGUAGES

English (Fluent) · German (Fluent) · Dutch (Fluent)